flight back to Mumbai.

‘May You Live in Interesting Times’

The Chinese have a saying: ‘May you live in interesting times.’ I can’t complain on that account. As governor of the Reserve Bank for five years, I had more, much more, than my share of interesting times. The crisis began days after I assumed office and continued in some form or other all through my tenure without even a week’s respite. The most frequently asked question of me during those early months was about when the crisis would end. I used to joke that since the folklore was that the new governor was responsible for inflicting the crisis on India, it would be logical to expect it to end only when his tenure ended. For good measure, I used to tell them when my term would end.

Many will recall that the last few months of my tenure in 2013 were marked by the pressures on the rupee as part of the global taper tantrums. As it happened, the rupee stabilized the week after I left the RBI. If there was one prediction that I would have liked to be wrong on, it would have been this one on the crisis ending with my governorship. But that was not to be my legacy!